In addressing inequalities between the various education system, the NCEPG 2018 have highlighted the importance of 'integrated education reforms' that would encompass the public, private and madrassa sector, creating 'vertical and horizontal linkages' across provinces and school systems (NACTA 2018, p. 5). The social contract between the citizen and the security state as discussed in Chapter 2 is further strengthened through such an uncritical education system. Far from challenging the fundamental ideological underpinnings of an exclusive Pakistani citizenship discourse in the curriculum as promoted by the education system, the security state in Pakistan is further normalizing its military-centric, Islamic narrative by bringing educational institutions into its counterextremism agenda.

Notes

1 Commonly known as the Sharif report.
2 This is still the case today: https://tribune.com.pk/story/333273/educational-bias-memorise-the-quran-for-twenty-extra-marks/
3 This is discussed in more detail below.
4 More recently the UNDP Human Development Report 2017 that surveyed youth across Pakistan said about its respondents: 'Most were schooled in a curriculum that forges an identity based exclusively on Islam, is discriminatory towards non-Muslim communities and cements an "us vs. them" mentality. Moreover, authority figures like parents, teachers and community leaders often discourage secular inquiry, critical thinking, and discussion of alternative visions of religion, society and state. It is worrying that almost half of all the NYPS respondents said they do not approve of having friendly relations with non-Muslims or Muslims of other sects, the right of these "other" communities to build places of worship, and especially, to preach their faith' (p. 110).
5 'You are free; you are free to go to your temples. You are free to go to your mosques or to any other places of worship in this State of Pakistan. You may belong to any religion, caste or creed – that has nothing to do with the business of the state.' – Mohammed Ali Jinnah, 8 November 1947.
6 P.b.u.h. – Peace be upon him.
7 'Clear differences between schools were observed here again with government schools focusing on the sacrifice of the previous generations, whilst madrassas couched being Pakistani in religious terms. Philanthropic schools had a wider definition encompassing culture, religion and parental sacrifice whilst private schools had more patriotic slogans. Anger, anti Indian sentiment and discontent